



PROGRESS REPORT

Nigeria: progress report, September 2025 – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-08 · 367 systems and instruments tracked

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

This report asks the same set of questions of every country. The rows below are a fixed frame of indicators, one row each, chosen in advance and covering all thirty-eight subjects the base tracks — so what appears here is decided by the frame and not by whichever records happened to accumulate. Each row says what happened on that indicator during the period, with every claim linked to the source it rests on.

Where a row reads *No evidence*, the base holds nothing on that indicator. **That is a statement about this base, not about the country** — it does not mean nothing exists, only that nothing has been collected here yet. The rows that carry evidence say what it is; the rows that do not are left to speak for themselves.

The period is 2025-09-01 to 2026-09-08.

Progress values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, regulations still pending*.

Governance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Digital transformation strategy	A presidential committee and a civil service working committee sit above a digital public infrastructure framework still in development against a 2027 services target. The presidential committee on implementation was constituted in May 2025 and is operating (committee). An eleven-member civil service technical working committee was inaugurated in August 2026, tasked with drafting the architecture, roadmap and governance mechanisms within one week ahead of a steering committee; no terms of reference, budget or publication commitment is stated (working committee). The framework itself remains in development against a target of 75 per cent of public services digitised by 2027 on an integrated-government model (framework).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	ICT strategy	The National Telecommunications Policy is being rewritten for the first time since 2000, a licensing regime built for voice and messaging. The rewrite was under way in May 2026 (rewrite). A licensing regime built for voice and short messaging is cited as a reason hyperscalers route investment to other African markets, which is the argument the rewrite has to answer. No draft, timetable or consultation is published.	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Broadband strategy	A Spectrum Roadmap 2026-2030 would raise assignable spectrum from 1.07 GHz to about 3.8 GHz, and about 3,700 towers are to deploy from October 2026. The roadmap targets at least 96 per cent 4G population coverage and at least 50 per cent for 5G by 2030, sets a median quality benchmark rising from 20-22 Mbps to 65-80 Mbps, and treats satellite direct-to-device as the complement for riverine, border and blackspot communities (roadmap); the universal service fund identifies 87 clusters holding approximately 23 million people (roadmap). Resource mobilisation and contracting are stated complete for about 3,700 towers reaching more than 20 million people, with a first tower in Delta State and riverine communities targeted before mid-2027 (towers); the count, the population figure and the dates are the government's own and no contract value or supplier is stated (towers, approval).	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Data storage / cloud strategy	A National Digital Cloud Policy makes cloud the default for new federal systems and sorts data into four levels, above cloud guidelines signed with no published text and a draft data and cloud policy five years in draft. The policy is in force apart from its sovereignty provisions, which await presidential approval. It pools ministry demand through the government infrastructure company under framework agreements, and sorts government and regulated data into four levels, the highest hosted only in Nigeria and the next stored at rest in Nigeria; it imposes no general localisation on commercial data, and sets a private cloud and data-centre investment target of US\$250m within 12 months rising to US\$750m within 24 months (policy, announcement). Cloud computing and technical guidelines were signed at a ceremony in August 2026 with implementation beginning immediately in phases, and scope, obligations and thresholds unstated because no text is published (guidelines, signing). A separate draft national policy on data and cloud has been in draft since 2021, and the localisation question was settled by circular instead (draft).	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Data interoperability framework / roadmap	Draft technical standards for digital public infrastructure have been in draft since April 2025 with nothing published since. The standards were in draft in April 2025 and remain so (standards). A national data exchange is meanwhile moving personal data in production behind the government service portal, so the exchange is running ahead of the standards that would govern it.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	AI strategy	The National AI Strategy is still in development with its Trust approved, while the country ranks 38th of 135 on a responsible-AI index and Africa's highest. The National AI Trust was approved by the Federal Executive Council in February 2025 to mobilise resources and provide oversight, building on a 2024 draft strategy and the national artificial-intelligence research centre; the strategy itself is still in development (trust). The country scores 45.93 and 38th of 135 on the 2026 responsible-AI index, Africa's highest, and 72nd on a government readiness index against 141st three years earlier; the responsible-AI index's own conclusion is that holding policies is not the same as enforceable oversight or deployed systems, and both are composite scores built largely from policy documents (indices).	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Data localisation policies	A central bank circular requires payment data generated in Nigeria to be stored there by 1 January 2027, against more than 85 per cent of workloads on public clouds. The circular requires payment transaction data generated in Nigeria to be stored and managed in Nigeria by 1 January 2027, with ultimate beneficial ownership disclosure and market-concentration caps; the circular text itself is not held (circular, directive, dilemma). An analysing firm estimates US\$850m a year spent on offshore data hosting and about 90 per cent of Nigerian payment data currently held abroad (analysis). More than 85 per cent of Nigerian workloads sit on public clouds and 22 per cent of the thousand most-accessed sites are hosted locally against a 34 per cent sub-Saharan average (dependence); the concentration risk is an expert's characterisation rather than a measured exposure (dependence, costs).	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Data governance policy	A memorandum with the Governors' Forum extends federal data-protection governance to state level, against a cloud policy still in draft. The data protection commission and the Governors' Forum signed a memorandum on 7 May 2026 creating an implementation partnership and working group to deepen data protection and privacy governance at state level — the first instrument the base holds reaching below the federal tier. The federal instruments it would extend are the Data Protection Act 2023 and its enforcement regime. The policy that would govern government data more broadly is not made: the national policy on data and cloud remains in draft. No state has been reported adopting anything under the memorandum.	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Open data policy	A national data action plan for 2025 to 2028 was launched in December 2025 above the 2018 open data policy. The action plan launched on 15 December 2025 is a coordinated national data roadmap, the first national data instrument since 2018; the base holds the statistics bureau's catalogue record because the published document carries no extractable text. The 2018 open data policy remains the only national instrument expressly titled one and still governs the national portal and agency publication obligations. Neither has a compliance report, review or dataset inventory behind it, so whether agencies meet their publication obligations is still unestablished.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	Data protection legislation	The Data Protection Act 2023 is in force with an amendment bill before the assembly, and the first damages award under it was made in July 2026. The Act is criticised as structurally weak in placing the commission under ministerial control, and its section 63 gives it primacy over any inconsistent law on personal-data processing; the federal government and the governors' forum have been urging states to implement it, which is an admission that the tier handling civil registration, health, education and land records is not yet compliant (Act, accountability). An amendment bill was introduced in July 2026 (bill). A court awarded ₦15m general damages, costs and post-judgment interest for marketing after consent was withdrawn, grounded on the Act, the constitutional privacy provision and the consumer-protection Act together; it held personal data must be erased on termination but refused wholesale deletion where statutory banking retention applies (judgment). 2026-09-03 - the commission opened validation of a data privacy framework for electronic commerce at an Abuja workshop run with the German development agency, following a private-sector session in Lagos. No draft text, scope, commencement date or enforcement route is published.	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Cybersecurity legislation	The Cybercrimes (Amendment) Act 2024 is in force, and lawyers argue enforcement agencies misapply it against dissent rather than cyber threats. Civil-society lawyers argue the Act is misapplied against dissent, with most such cases collapsing because complainants never testify; the financial sector alone lost ₦53.4bn to cybercrime in 2024 (Act). No prosecution, conviction or dismissal series under the Act is published, so the claim of misuse and the claim of necessity rest on the same absence of data.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	Legislation covering digital id	The NIMC Act 2026 makes the identity number the foundational credential, and a legal reading puts mandatory use across passports, banking, telecommunications and land dealings. The Act replaces the 2007 statute, recognises the identity number as the foundational credential under a one-person-one-identity policy, incorporates the data-protection regime and lets the commission prosecute identity fraud; the gazetted text was still not publicly available about six weeks after assent, so neither the expansion reading nor the counter-reading can be checked against it (Act, transformation, analysis). On a law firm's reading the commission becomes the root certification authority for a national public key infrastructure and the national biometric-data repository, use of the number is made mandatory across four named sectors, the Act states that proof of identity is not proof of eligibility or citizenship, and unauthorised database access carries penalties of at least NGN10m or five years for an individual (reading).	ADVANCED

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Legislation and regulation	Digital payments legislation	Crypto sits inside the securities perimeter, an executive order created a coordinating council, draft virtual-asset rules set capital thresholds and a stablecoin licensing regime is drafted. The Investments and Securities Act 2025 put crypto inside the securities perimeter (Act), and an executive order of July 2026 created a Virtual Asset Council and Office with its secretariat at the central bank, creating no new regulator and transferring no powers (order). Draft rules out for comment set N500m minimum capital for digital-asset platforms, N200m for service providers, a N30m registration fee, local incorporation and a resident chief executive (rules, data). A drafted issuer-licensing regime for fiat-collateralised stablecoins requires full reserves with licensed Nigerian banks, daily reconciliation and monthly audited publication; no instrument is issued (regime). The securities regulator has admitted further firms to an incubation programme with no graduation route published (incubation), and the central bank intends to run observer nodes on approved stablecoin blockchains (nodes). 2026-08-31 — the same draft also carries custody and incident duties: customer assets segregated from the firm's own with 80% held offline, N2bn minimum capital for exchanges and custodians, a fidelity bond of at least 25% of that minimum, incidents notified within 24 hours and reported within 48, and SEC approval before a foreign-issued stablecoin is listed. No commencement date or transition period is stated.	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Legislation enabling data interoperability	A National Digital Economy and E-Governance Bill before the assembly would elevate the technology agency to a super regulator, with overlap flagged by stakeholders. The bill offers a unified legal framework with broad supervisory and enforcement powers, and also carries the risk-based artificial-intelligence regime (bill). Its electronic-signature provisions overlap with the root certification authority the identity statute already created, and which instrument governs digital signatures is unresolved on the record.	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	AI legislation / regulations	A risk-based regime sits in an unpassed bill, competition law was turned on AI training over Nigerian journalism, and judicial officers called for authentication standards. High-risk systems in finance, public administration, surveillance and automated decision-making would face annual impact assessments with fines up to ₦10m or 2 per cent of Nigerian revenue (bill); an external reading finds the bill envisages risk assessment without categorising risk into levels, and a domestic critique warns it concentrates broad powers in agencies that lack proven capacity (bill, control, governance). A presidential directive of July 2026 covers alleged anti-competitive practices, unlawful exploitation of news content and other unfair conduct by major global technology and generative artificial-intelligence firms; it followed a press-organisation petition and no terms of reference or interim finding is published (directive, scope). Fifty-four judicial officers called for stricter authentication standards for AI-generated evidence and a review of the digital-evidence, cybercrime and privacy statutes; a communique carries no legal force and no legislative response is on record (communique). A university-system artificial-intelligence framework has been written and three tertiary regulators committed to harmonise (tertiary).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	E-commerce legislation	A US\$222m consumer-protection penalty is under appeal, enforcement of new platform rules was paused in July 2026, and a local-presence bill went to public consultation. The penalty was imposed in 2025 and is under appeal, distinct from the data-protection track (penalty). The minister paused enforcement of new internet-platform rules pending a unified national digital-economy policy framework, convening a joint technical committee of three regulators to resolve overlapping mandates (pause). An amendment requiring large platforms to maintain physical offices went to a Senate committee hearing and then to public consultation; a coalition backed passage on an investment case while a rights organisation calls for withdrawal over a power it reads as letting the commission prohibit a non-compliant platform's activities after thirty days without adequate judicial safeguards, and thresholds, deadlines, sanctions and appeal routes are still undefined (bill, hearing, legislation).	MIXED a US\$222m platform penalty under appeal and a local-presence bill in consultation while enforcement of new platform rules was paused
Legislation and regulation	Statistics legislation	The Statistics Bill 2025 passed third reading in December 2025 and went to public hearing in June 2026. The House of Representatives passed the bill at third reading on 10 December 2025, to repeal the 2007 Act and redefine the statistics bureau's powers and funding. Its committee held a public hearing on 8 June 2026, at which the speaker and the statistician-general described the bill as a complete overhaul of the 2007 Act rather than an amendment. The Statistics Act 2007 remains operative. No Senate stage and no assent is on record, so the bill is two chambers short of law.	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Access to information legislation	Two Federal High Court judgments in the window held the Act binds an incorporated public company and overrides other disclosure laws. On 13 October 2025 the Federal High Court held the national oil company remains a public institution subject to the Act despite being a company limited by shares, and ordered disclosure of the terms of a \$3 billion crude-for-cash loan. On 24 February 2026 the same court held the Act overrides other disclosure laws and regulations, ordering a public council to release data-protection policy records. The statute itself is untouched: the Act was assented on 28 May 2011 and remains in force. What moved is its reach, and by judgment rather than by amendment; no compliance report, request volume or refusal statistic is published.	ADVANCED
Data protection	Data protection authority	The commission has taken compliance above 55 per cent on a remediation-first model, imposed a ₦766m penalty, opened multinational investigations and had a platform fund its capacity programme. Compliance lifted from about 4 per cent of organisations to above 55 per cent by March 2025 (enforcement); twenty-one-day notices went to 1,369 organisations in 2025 and more than a thousand educational institutions in 2026, and a forensic investigation was opened in August 2026 into a federal university, a bank and a technology vendor over students' data allegedly used to open bank accounts without consent (enforcement, schools, investigation). The Federal High Court upheld the power to designate and register controllers of major importance, reaching agents, banks, telcos, health and digital platforms (court). The largest fine to date, ₦766,242,500, was imposed expressly for want of cooperation, and whether it was paid, contested or varied is not established (fine). Multinational platforms are under investigation (probes), and a two-year capacity programme is funded under a court-approved settlement with a United States platform (settlement).	ADVANCED

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Data protection	National data protection readiness	A circular directs every federal agency to appoint data protection officers, and its own text is not in the public record; a suit was filed against the electoral commission for operating without a privacy policy. The circular directs all ministries, departments and agencies to appoint qualified officers and register them, engage licensed compliance organisations, make budgetary provision and file audit returns, and makes permanent secretaries and chief executives personally responsible; it is the first instrument on file pointing the Act's enforcement apparatus at the public sector rather than at banks, schools and telcos, and searches of the government's own resource portal returned nothing three days after the announcement (circular). A Federal High Court suit was filed against the electoral commission for operating without a website privacy policy, following an exposé and a voter-record leak (suit). The commission has a memorandum with the communications regulator (memorandum) and agreed collaboration with the securities regulator with no joint supervisory arrangement stated (collaboration), while artificial-intelligence-generated identity fraud rose 192 per cent in one quarter as document forgery fell 80 (fraud).	MIXED the Act's enforcement apparatus pointed at the public sector for the first time while the instrument doing it is not published
Regional collaboration	Regional policy collaboration	An Abuja Declaration on meaningful connectivity was adopted with machinery to argue it internationally, and the country leads a digital trade regulators group and a trilateral customs committee. The declaration was adopted at a continental conference in Abuja in July 2026, with machinery to argue the position at the international union (declaration). The country was named lead of a group harmonising market entry, licensing and regulatory cooperation for African digital service firms, with guidelines named as a first output and none published (group). A joint communique with two neighbours committed three customs administrations to a trilateral steering committee on digital interoperability, harmonised procedures and coordinated risk management at two corridors, with no funding, timeline or output published (customs), and an artificial-intelligence and cyber diplomacy unit sits inside the foreign ministry coordinating engagement on emerging technologies (unit).	ADVANCED
Regional collaboration	Regional legal harmonisation	The regional biometric identity card has been in issue since November 2025, while a peer-reviewed review records the country as a non-signatory to the continental convention. The regional card entered issue in November 2025 to support regional travel and security (card). A peer-reviewed review of health-data governance in four countries records only one of them as a signatory to the continental cyber and data convention, and finds all four frameworks fragmented with weak cross-border transfer harmonisation and capacity gaps (review). A country issuing a regional credential while outside the regional data instrument is the shape here.	MIXED a regional biometric card in issue while the continental cyber and data convention is unsigned
Regional collaboration	Shared regional infrastructure	The country is one of three first pilots for shared cross-border identity, payment and data rails, and a subsea cable to Equatorial Guinea bundles a data centre with it. The country implementation forum for the cross-border rails pilot was inaugurated in Abuja in July 2026 (pilot, selection). The cable agreement was signed in February 2026 and bundles a commercial data centre, so local hosting rides in on the cross-border link (cable, account).	ADVANCED

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Regional collaboration	Cross-border data transfers	A bilateral health memorandum and its specimen sharing agreement require sharing within five days of a United States request, against membership of a cross-border privacy forum. The memorandum was signed in December 2025 with planned United States support of US\$1,953,530,560 against Nigeria's US\$2,975,634,499 (memorandum); a rights organisation's reading of seven signed memoranda puts Nigeria among five whose text requires unilateral sharing of specimens and pathogen-sequencing data and among two whose data-sharing arrangement is deferred to an unpublished appendix, with all seven requiring broad audit access (memorandum, assessment, complaint). Every page is stamped not for public release. The specimen agreement entered force in January 2026 for a renewable five-year term, requiring sharing within five days of a request with no numerical cap on onward sharing with non-governmental United States entities (agreement). The country joined a global cross-border privacy rules forum in April 2025 (forum).	ADVANCED
Standards	National interoperability standards	A government enterprise architecture was handed to the technology agency in April 2026 and piloted at four agencies, alongside a digital trustmark. The architecture was built over about two and a half years with a foreign development agency, is hosted by the government infrastructure company and was piloted at the identity commission, customs, immigration and the technology agency (handover, takeover). A digital trustmark has been in issue since October 2025 (trustmark). Neither carries a published conformance standard, adoption count or list of bound systems.	ADVANCED
Standards	National quality standards	A digital infrastructure assurance framework was signed with no published text, an innovation hub standards framework is at validation, and the web design standards have published no toolkit a year on. The assurance framework was signed in August 2026 with no published text and no stated obligations, thresholds or commencement date; the central bank tied the programme to financial stability on the ground that payment platforms, cloud, cybersecurity, networks and digital identity are now financial infrastructure (assurance). A draft hub standards framework gives innovation hubs a self-assessment tool across seven dimensions and about thirty-five criteria, validated against a count of more than 339 hubs concentrated in two cities (hubs). The compensation framework binds mobile operators and fires where the commission confirms a missed quality target in a named local government area, paying automatic airtime credit with no appeal on the amount; the directive instrument itself is not published and the qualifying thresholds are referred out to regulations the base does not hold (compensation). 2026-08-31 — the web design standards, launched in July 2025 with a toolkit promised within eight to ten weeks ahead of rule-making and Federal Executive Council approval, had published none by August 2026, and two publications searching public materials found no evidence of approval or implementation. The ministry's 2025 year in review still lists the launch as an achievement. No revised timetable is published: the commitment stands unmet.	MIXED three frameworks advanced while the web design standards stalled with no toolkit published

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Standards	Adoption of international standards	Payments migrated to ISO 20022, crypto trades are reported to the international framework, the passport joined the aviation key directory, and a software assurance framework is proposed. The payments migration completed in 2025 with point-of-sale geo-tagging (migration), and crypto trade reporting against tax and identity numbers went live in January 2026 aligned to the international crypto-asset reporting framework (reporting). Integration with the civil aviation public key directory moved the passport from machine-readable to cryptographically verifiable at 111 member states' borders (passport). A national software quality assurance framework consolidates development, testing and licensing guidelines with an accessibility standard for citizen-facing platforms, tiers risk with core banking and national identity infrastructure in the top class, makes certification a condition of project clearance and sets full operation for 2027; it is not adopted and no licensed testing organisation is on file (framework); automated anti-money-laundering baseline standards were mandated in March 2026, shifting the test from tooling to governance, integration and explainability (baseline).	ADVANCED
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Non-governmental contribution to national policy	A civil-society body built an artificial-intelligence tracker of online gender-based violence with more than 20,000 verified cases, and another monitors parties digital-rights compliance at elections. The tracker uses machine learning, localised keywords and context analysis to detect, categorise and monitor abuse in real time, flags actionable cases and produces evidence for referral; it is a civil-society body building the measurement layer the state has not (tracker). A separate platform tracks political parties' websites and social media for data-privacy violations and access restrictions during elections, piloted at a state governorship election with no findings published (monitor).	ADVANCED
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Open discussion of government policy	A rights organisation and the editors' guild jointly called for enforcement of the Cybercrimes Act to be suspended pending repeal or revision, and no government response is on file. The state security service offered to pause its cybercrimes prosecution of a campaigner until after the 2027 election, and was told that pausing is not the remedy sought (report). The charges stand. They argue the 2024 amendment failed to cure the defect a regional court identified in 2022 when it ruled the original cyberstalking section vague, arbitrary and in breach of the African Charter, and that the amended text keeps ambiguous wording under which a prosecution can turn on someone claiming to feel fear (call). The call cites extrajudicial arrests, malicious prosecutions, enforced disappearances and unlawful surveillance reaching as far as posts in private messaging groups. No government or prosecutorial response is on file.	REGRESSED

Finance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure	Sustainable domestic financing of digital transformation	A 50 per cent tariff reset in 2025 and removal of the 5 per cent telecom excise preceded about ₦2.13tn of sector capital spending in 2025. The tariff increase was the first in about eleven years, approved after naira devaluation drove sector losses reported at about US\$11.3bn forgone over the freeze (reset, losses), and the excise duty was removed in August 2025 (excise). The operators' association puts about ₦2.13tn invested in 2025 with about ₦1.86tn planned for 2026, credits the tariff adjustment with moving the industry from severe financial pressure to reinvestment, and says a substantial share is financed from domestic capital that capital-importation statistics never capture; no regulator or statistical series corroborates the totals (capital spending).	ADVANCED
MoUs and other agreements	Strategic relationships	A EUR 45 million tranche completed an EUR 820 million European digital package, and a bilateral digitalisation memorandum was signed with Finland. The tranche signed on 9 December 2025 completes an EUR 820 million digital economy package supporting a 90,000-kilometre fibre backbone, digital public services and skills — the largest single strategic digital relationship the base holds. A memorandum with Finland signed at Abuja on 23 March 2026 covers digital government, digital public infrastructure, cybersecurity, innovation support and capacity building. There is still no single umbrella instrument: the finance ministry's international economic relations department is the administrative home, and publishes no list of relationships or financing volumes.	ADVANCED
New investments	Mobilisation of non-state finance	Telecoms foreign direct investment reached US\$392.91m in nine months, a fibre bond and an agritech commercial paper raised local capital, and a domestic seed fund closed at US\$84m. Foreign direct investment in telecoms reached US\$392.91m in the first nine months of 2025, the strongest since 2019 and up from a 2021 low of US\$107.46m, attributed to the tariff reset and naira stability (investment). A ₦4.05bn first tranche of a ₦20bn bond programme closed through a special purpose vehicle; the size is trivial against the donor lines and the financing route is the finding, long-dated local capital in a market whose rates push savings to short maturities (bond, tranche). An agricultural technology company raised ₦5.3bn in the first series of an approved ₦50bn commercial paper programme, oversubscribed against a ₦5bn target (paper), and a domestic seed-stage firm closed its second fund at US\$84m, within US\$23m of the total raised by all six African venture funds that closed in 2025 (fund). 2026-08-26 — the manager's own release puts the second fund at US\$84m against a US\$75m target, oversubscribed, naming a European reconstruction bank, a Norwegian development financier and a university foundation among new limited partners joining a base that already held the World Bank's private-sector arm and British and French development financiers.	ADVANCED

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New investments	Development-partner project financing	A US\$430m identity programme runs to the end of 2026, US\$110m of startup debt opened for applications, and a six-year country framework puts broadband at the centre of lending. The identity financing is US\$430m from three lenders, approved in 2020 and restructured in December 2024, raising the enrolment target from 148m to 180m and extending closing to the end of 2026 (financing, restructuring). US\$110m in debt financing for technology startups opened for applications in July 2026 (debt), and a six-year country partnership framework puts electricity, broadband and private capital at the centre of the lending programme with no digital lending line itemised (framework). A startup hub programme of US\$51.2m runs alongside (hub), and a development finance institution extended US\$150m for operator network upgrades (upgrades). 2026-09-07 - the identity project's eleventh implementation status report rates it Moderately Satisfactory on both progress towards its development objective and overall implementation, at Substantial overall risk, with the system-integrator contract for the modular open-source rebuild awarded and signature expected by end-July 2026 on an implementation period of about eighteen months. No signature confirmation, contract value or integrator name is published.	ADVANCED

ICT Infrastructure

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Mobile penetration	188m mobile subscriptions and 157m internet subscribers sit above 4G population coverage of about 85 per cent, while a roaming remedy has produced no subscriber recovery. Two regulator series run side by side: mobile subscriptions at 188m with broadband penetration 55.67 per cent in April 2026, up from 50 per cent in November 2025, and internet subscribers at about 157m in May 2026, up 2.67m in the month (subscriptions); the internet series counts active data-using lines, so reactivation and acquisition are indistinguishable in it (subscriptions, internet). Population coverage runs 4G at about 85 per cent and 5G at about 13 per cent against 2030 targets of at least 96 and at least 50 (coverage); 2G reaches 95.31 per cent and 3G 89.42 (coverage, roadmap). Close to a year after national roaming was approved as a remedy, the beneficiary operator was flat at 802,534 internet subscribers for a second month (roaming), while a competitor grew from about 13,000 to about 17,200 sites in three years (retail).	ADVANCED

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Connectivity	Internet usage	Fibre overtook fixed wireless for the first time with median fixed download at 34.47 Mbps, and rural medians rose on the regulator's crowdsourced measurement. Fibre-to-the-premises connections reached 265,000 by June 2026 from 84,141 at the end of 2025, the median fixed download speed rose 155 per cent to 34.47 Mbps, uploads nearly doubled and latency fell (mix); the gain sits at the bottom of the distribution, the slowest decile improving from 2.24 to 6.04 Mbps while the fastest moved only from 74.37 to 90.04 (mix). Rural median download rose from 15.0 to 16.4 Mbps and rural latency fell, on a test base growing from 266,970 to 543,123 (measurement); only 31.4 per cent of 5G-capable devices in the capital territory and 27.5 in Lagos actually use 5G, unchanged over six months, with a negative promoter score for every carrier (measurement, geospatial). One operator is live in five cities with six further states named for launch before the end of 2026 (footprint), and the largest operator is building toward a target of 8m fibre homes by 2028 (homes).	ADVANCED
Connectivity	Mobile affordability	Sub-US\$100 smartphone shipments fell 34 per cent in a quarter with the African average price up US\$41, and consumer cloud storage rose more than 50 per cent on some plans. A global memory-chip shortage turns device cost into a digital-divide variable in a market that imports almost every computer it sells: sub-US\$100 shipments fell 34 per cent year on year in the second quarter of 2026, the continental average selling price rose US\$41 to US\$202, and the Nigerian market fell 11 per cent in the quarter as buyers delayed purchases (devices); the analyst's stated cause is artificial-intelligence data-centre demand for memory making US\$75 devices unprofitable to build (devices, laptops). A single provider raised consumer cloud storage prices by more than 50 per cent on some plans, with Nigerian users facing increases of up to 52 per cent (storage); it is the only dated consumer cloud price the base holds (storage).	REGRESSED
Connectivity	National fibre backbone	Project BRIDGE has a US\$1.6bn appraised envelope and an October 2026 start, against about 101,000 km already built that bypasses some 130m Nigerians. The programme's special purpose vehicle is incorporated with private investors at 51 to 75 per cent and the state at 25 to 49 (execution); the minister stated in August 2026 that the 90,000 km rollout begins in October and that funding is raised, against the 2027 start for physical deployment the project documents carry (execution, rollout, envelope). The financier's own two figures are five weeks apart and on different bases: an appraisal counting 30,000 km of terrestrial fibre deployed against the 120,000 km the national blueprint requires and stating flatly that there is no national backbone network, and a board statement framing the programme as extending the backbone from 35,000 km to 125,000 (appraisal, approval). About 101,000 km of fibre has been built and the finding is that it bypasses some 130m Nigerians, a utilisation and last-mile problem rather than a backbone one (utilisation); an operator lit a 400G and 800G optical backbone in October 2025 (optical).	MIXED a 90,000 km open-access programme moving into execution while the fibre already built bypasses 130m people

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	International internet bandwidth	A second international breakout via the 2Africa cable was announced, and ring-protected transit was activated across four cable systems. An operator announced on 7 February 2026 a second international breakout landing at Kwa Ibo in Akwa Ibom, reducing dependence on Lagos as the sole breakout — the first structural change to the country's landing geography the base records. A wholesale carrier reports activating ring-protected transit across four cable systems, giving carriers serving Nigeria east-to-east and west-to-west redundancy against a single-cable failure; it is the carrier's own account on its corporate channel. Neither carries a capacity figure. The last official one remains the 2020 broadband plan: six submarine cables at Lagos, over 40 Tbps available and under 10 per cent used, now six years old.	ADVANCED
Connectivity	Internet Exchange Points	The national internet exchange passed 1 Tbps of traffic in April 2025, and close to twelve licence-exempt optical links now carry urban transport across Lagos. The exchange passed a 1 Tbps traffic milestone in April 2025 (exchange). Two companies say they deployed close to twelve wireless optical links across Lagos over two years, distributing bandwidth from points of presence to banks, internet providers, hotels and a utility, rated at up to 20 Gbps over up to 20 km, with three further cities named next; the links need no trenching, civil works or spectrum licence, so a high-capacity urban transport layer sits outside the spectrum instruments the regulator uses to shape the market (links, deployment).	ADVANCED
Connectivity	Satellite broadband licensing and availability	Satellite service became the second-largest provider then paused orders over congestion, a second landing permit was granted with no service, and two national satellites were approved for 2028 and beyond. The incumbent satellite service became the country's second-largest internet provider on late-2024 figures, then paused new orders in parts of two cities over congestion in September 2025, and was brought inside the regulator's biometric subscriber-verification regime with more than 66,000 users required to submit identity numbers and headshots (provider, congestion, verification). A landing permit for a second constellation was granted in January 2026 with no service (permit). Cabinet approved the acquisition of two high-throughput communications satellites in August 2026 on an operator timetable of 2028 and 2029 or 2030, with no contract value published and negotiation still to follow (satellites, approval); a low-earth-orbit partnership announced in January 2025 has no service (partnership) and a direct-to-device memorandum targeted for end-2025 has nothing on file (direct to device).	MIXED the largest satellite provider paused orders over congestion and was brought inside biometric verification while three further satellite programmes remain unbuilt

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (all providers)	About 26 facilities carry 50 to 56 MW of declared live capacity on one count and about 28 MW on another, with a US\$250m hyperscale campus and a 4.5 MW operator facility among the builds. One trade tracker maps about 26 facilities, eighteen of them commercial colocation, at about 50 to 56 MW of declared live capacity rising to about 124 MW when design specifications are counted; an independent research house measuring capacity active, under lease or readily available puts it at about 28 MW across about fifteen live facilities against about 80 MW at full build. The two counts are not reconcilable without their definitions, and the country is Africa's second-largest market at about 15 per cent of continental capacity (estate, briefing). A credit rating agency puts national capacity at about 197 MW in September 2026, a third basis again, and rates power availability for data centres very low, citing self-generation and grid instability (rating). A US\$250m campus backed by the sovereign wealth fund is in build toward about 100 MW (campus), an operator's first phase runs 4.5 MW and 780 racks scaling to 9-14 MW (operator), a colocation facility is expanding to 24 MW by 2027 (expansion), a 2 MW facility opened in Lagos in 2025 (facility), and a second operator announced a 38 MW build of more than 3,000 racks at over US\$120m (build).	ADVANCED
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (national providers)	The sovereign wealth fund announced a 100MW hyperscale data centre campus in Lagos (announcement). The sovereign wealth fund announced a 100MW artificial-intelligence-ready hyperscale campus in Lagos, offering co-location, cloud, storage and high-performance compute (announcement). It is announced, not built: no construction start, cost or completion date is stated. The government cloud delivers document storage, mail, content management and electronic signature through the state infrastructure company across ministries (cloud). The sovereign cloud initiative's implementation taskforce was inaugurated in August 2026 to align regulators, institutions and private operators behind technical standards, cloud governance, infrastructure assurance and investment frameworks; Nigerian organisations are estimated to spend about US\$850m a year on foreign cloud infrastructure against a policy target of US\$750m in private investment within 24 months, and how the taskforce relates to a joint technical committee inaugurated four days earlier is not established (initiative, taskforce). A pan-African operator's national sovereign cloud went live in March 2026 (operator cloud), subsidised sovereign cloud opened for startups in May 2026 (subsidy), and one sovereign-cloud build rides partly on a Chinese stack (stack).	ADVANCED
Data Storage	Off-site backup capacity	A Lagos cloud region gives one platform three separate legal jurisdictions, and an edge facility opened in January 2026. The Lagos region is a full compute region in a carrier-neutral facility, the third alongside two others, framed around data residency since the data protection Act took effect and giving three separate legal jurisdictions across the platform (region). An edge facility entered service in January 2026 (edge). No disaster-recovery arrangement, replication rule or backup requirement for government systems is published anywhere in this base.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Energy	Sufficient energy and water for data centres	The grid has never reliably exceeded 6 GW for about 230m people, while an operator venture targets 150 MW in a first phase spanning two countries. Grid availability runs at roughly 41 per cent, diesel backup costs US\$0.40 to US\$0.50 a kilowatt-hour against US\$0.05 to US\$0.10 on the grid in two comparable markets and adds about 40 per cent to operating cost, and construction runs about US\$12 a watt (grid). A Gulf-backed venture in which the operator group holds a minority stake targets 150 MW in a first phase spanning South Africa and Nigeria; no Nigerian site, split, cost or commissioning date is stated (venture). Announced compute capacity is being planned against a grid that cannot presently carry it.	REGRESSED
Energy	Grid reliability	The regulator recorded three grid collapses across the window, the latest with 7.96 per cent transmission loss and 32.72 per cent plant availability. The regulator's quarterly reports record the sequence. Its third-quarter 2025 report logs a total national collapse on 10 September 2025 at 11:20, restored by 11:48; its fourth-quarter 2025 report a partial collapse on 29 December 2025, with 7.27 per cent transmission loss and frequency and voltage outside the Grid Code ranges; and its first-quarter 2026 report a total collapse on 23 January 2026 and a partial one on 27 January, with 7.96 per cent transmission loss and 32.72 per cent plant availability. That is three collapses in four quarters, on the regulator's own statutory reporting. The standing position it sits against is that the grid has never reliably exceeded 6 GW for about 230 million people, roughly 41 per cent availability.	REGRESSED
Energy	Rural electrification	The communications regulator and the rural electrification agency signed a data-sharing memorandum overlaying electrification and universal-service deployment data. The agency supplies geospatial electrification data and the regulator its universal service fund deployment data, overlaid to find joint connectivity-and-energy gaps; it is the first Nigerian instrument to treat rural electrification and connectivity planning data as one dataset, and no amount, timeline or funding source is stated (memorandum).	ADVANCED
Technical Capacity	Robustness of government hardware and software	Human-resource modules run across more than 508 agencies and 600,000 civil servants, while the identity platform is not sized for compulsory use across fourteen sectors. The modules cover biometric onboarding, establishment management, payroll administration, mobility, self-service and workforce analytics, migrated to a locally built platform and placed under a domestic-first policy as strengthening the sovereignty of government personnel data (modules). Servers, databases and networks are not sized for compulsory use of the identity number across the fourteen sectors the amended Act reaches, and a compulsory register carries an election-integrity risk if it cannot be relied on (capacity).	MIXED a payroll and human-resource platform live across 508 agencies while the identity platform is not sized for the compulsory use the new Act requires

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Technical Capacity	Local capacity to maintain, manage and develop government systems	155,397 fibre cuts in two months with more than 54,000 attributed to vandalism, more than 5,000 cuts from road works in a half-year, and a standing protection committee with no published powers. Cuts ran at 155,397 across April and May 2026 alone against 19,384 cuts, 3,241 equipment thefts and more than 19,000 site-access denials across January to August 2025, an order-of-magnitude deterioration recorded despite the critical-infrastructure order gazetted in 2024 (vandalism); operators name vandalism, multiple taxation and right-of-way as the constraints on network quality rather than regulatory penalties (vandalism, cuts). The regulator separately counted more than 5,000 cuts from road works in the first half of 2026 (road works). A standing committee was formed with two ministries and the security adviser's office to coordinate protection of fibre designated critical national information infrastructure, with no terms of reference, meeting cycle, budget or enforcement power published (committee).	REGRESSED
Cybersecurity	National cybersecurity readiness	A Cyber Resilience Framework binds every licensed provider on a clock ending February 2027 with four-hour incident notification, and the police cybercrime centre recovered ₦8.82bn in 2024. The framework took effect in February 2026 and stages compliance in three tiers at six, nine and twelve months, running on five pillars with coded standards, tiering providers by network and sector role, placing accountability on boards and executive management, and binding to the data protection Act and the critical-infrastructure order; a guidance note of August 2026 adds a dedicated cybersecurity budget line, a chief information security officer and two-year in-country retention of call logs and traffic data (framework, notification, budgets). The police cybercrime centre was named the best African unit for 2024, recovering ₦8.82bn and arresting more than 751 suspects (police). A ministerial advisory council was announced with no membership or terms of reference published (council), and a bilateral partnership is rated more than 90 per cent implemented by the national coordinator, credited with the continent's first four certified incident-response auditors (partnership). 2026-09-07 - the police cybercrime centre's caseload reaches the base as about 146,000 reports logged and about 58bn naira in recovered assets, against ₦8.82bn recovered and more than 751 arrests in 2024. The cumulative period behind the newer figures is not stated. The new public fraud-reporting app is the fourth police reporting platform in a decade.	ADVANCED

DPI

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	National data exchange system	The national data exchange is moving personal data in production with no lawful basis on record, and practitioners describe the identity layer as federated linkage rather than integration. The exchange was built with European partners to end an eight-siloed-database problem and now moves personal data between agencies in production behind the government service portal; the lawful basis and audit arrangements for that sharing are unstated (exchange, launch). Named practitioners describe the identity number as a federated linkage system with a shared identifier rather than a fully integrated identity system, with banks still reconciling manually and buying third-party verification interfaces; this qualifies a single-source-of-truth framing stated three days earlier and neither source reconciles the two (linkage, fragmentation). A state is building a single patient-data platform connecting records, laboratory results and biological data across facilities, with no legal basis, controller arrangement, consent model or relationship to the national regime stated (health platform).	ADVANCED
Data Exchange	Use of digital id in other systems	Nine agencies took bilateral integration cover under the new identity Act in a fortnight, a telecom identity feed lets banks check SIM swaps, and the number is tied to health insurance records. Nine agencies concluded bilateral commitments across a single fortnight, and the electoral commission's chairman acknowledged the Act as a legal basis for resolving duplicate identities in the voter register; no account states a lawful basis, consent mechanism, retention rule or regulator role for the resulting sharing (agreements, partnerships). A joint feed between the central bank and the communications regulator lets banks check SIM-swap and recycled numbers before clearing, and fraud fell 51 per cent to ₦25.85bn in 2025 (feed). The identity number was tied to health insurance records in October 2025 (health).	ADVANCED
Data Exchange	Interoperability of health systems	A coordinating office was created in June 2026 to operationalise the national digital health architecture across public and private institutions. The President approved the National Health Technology and Data Analytics Office on 26 June 2026 and appointed a national coordinator, charged with operationalising the digital health architecture across public and private institutions. That architecture was endorsed for nationwide implementation by the National Council on Health in November 2025 and described as the sector's common rules of the road, covering a health information and claims exchange and national registries. The last count remains the minister's own: 7.2 million people on the exchange and more than 200 hospitals integrated. No independent count, facility list or published integration standard is held.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	Interoperability of education systems	A credential repository integrating more than 250 tertiary institutions was deployed, and the learner number was linked to the national identity register. The repository deployed in March 2026 integrates more than 250 tertiary institutions for real-time credential verification, against certificate fraud. The education ministry disclosed in July 2026 that the learner identification number has been integrated with the national identification number through the education management information system, extending trusted digital identity to nearly 80 million learners. Both sit on the national education data platform announced in June 2026, for which no go-live confirmation or record count is held.	ADVANCED
Data Exchange	Interoperability of social protection systems	A unified national architecture was flagged off in March 2026 to replace fragmented humanitarian and social-protection data systems. The system flagged off on 25 March 2026 sets out a unified national register, a poverty exit pathway and a poverty intelligence lab, explicitly to replace the fragmented humanitarian and social-protection data systems. The exchange it would run over is in production behind the government service portal, and a public review session in December 2025 took its draft technical standard and the life-events framework to federal and state stakeholders. The standard is still marked draft, no adopted version is held, and the lawful basis on which the exchange moves personal data is not on record.	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Robustness of system	117.5m people hold a number of 134.6m enrolments at 30 June 2026 against a 180m December target, and corrections are confined to a smartphone portal excluding about 72 per cent of adults. Registrations passed 136m by July 2026 from 123.9m in October 2025, against a target of 180m by the end of 2026; about 100m people are still uncaptured on the information minister's own figure, and enrolment runs 56.25 per cent male to 43.75 per cent female (registrations, enrolment, count). A 2024 policy confined corrections to a device-locked smartphone self-service portal, excluding the about 72 per cent of adults without smartphones and enabling agent charges of ₦12,000 to ₦62,000 against an official ₦2,000 (corrections); validly issued numbers are also being suspended over enrolment-centre bypass with reinstatement fees pushed onto citizens (corrections, regime). 2026-09-07 - the lender's own implementation report separates two counts the base had been carrying as one: 117,493,554 people hold a number out of 134,553,120 enrolments at 30 June 2026, from a 36,894,074 baseline of October 2019, against a target of 180,000,000 by December 2026, with females holding 40,424,403 of the numbers issued. Closing the gap would need monthly enrolment to rise from 1.5-1.8 million to about 7.4 million in the remaining six months. The commission's own figure of about 140 million, given to a publishers' roundtable in Lagos, is neither number and is not reconciled with either.	MIXED the count is now split between enrolments and numbers issued while corrections stay behind a portal most adults cannot reach

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	Registration of entire population	A ward-level drive opened free enrolment across all 8,809 wards, against a 22.3-point gender gap in who holds an identity number. Free enrolment runs in every ward across the 774 local government areas, targeting women, children, elderly people, persons with disabilities and refugees (drive, progress). Women are 38.8 per cent of enrolled holders against 61.1 per cent men, a 22.3-point gap (gap); in one state twenty-one centres serve about 7.5m people, a ₦3,000 round trip is prohibitive, no number means no access to the maternal-care fund, and rural women's phone ownership is 42 per cent against 78 urban (gap). The drive is aimed squarely at that gap and no post-drive gender figure is published. 2026-09-05 - a second use for election hardware was floated rather than agreed: the admissions board asked the electoral commission for biometric verification machines idle between elections, and the commission ordered a proof of concept to establish whether the devices are fit for that use. No device count, transfer basis, data-protection assessment or timetable is published, and the two registers rest on separate legal bases.	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	National maintenance of id and credentials systems	A multipurpose biometric card is in development with the payments switch, a cooperative identity credential is in revalidation, and border management is being biometrically strengthened. The three-in-one biometric card with multiple wallets is in development with the payments switch and the domestic card scheme, for agency services, student loans and farmer inputs (card, memorandum). A six-month revalidation exercise is under way to issue cooperatives a verification number and their members an identity credential under a memorandum with a private identity supplier; no cooperative or member count, cost, or link to the foundational register is stated (cooperatives). Border management is being strengthened through digital technology, biometric identity systems and intelligence sharing, on a statement at a forum rather than a procurement, with no system, vendor, cost or data-protection arrangement for the biometric collection stated (borders).	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Authentication	Consent-based verification went live in May 2025, the identity commission holds the national root certification authority, and airport identity verification runs on number and face. Consent-based verification launched in May 2025 (verification). The root certification authority role was handed over from the technology agency, with the wider partnership formalised in July 2026 covering the key-infrastructure transfer and harmonised digital-trust standards; it creates an overlap with the electronic-signature provisions of the still-pending economy bill, and which instrument governs digital signatures is unresolved (overlap, duties, certification). Travellers enrol identity number and face biometrics for digital security checks and boarding (airport).	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Digital id from birth	The registration platform is live nationwide from 1 July 2026 with about 57% of births registered, on a 2026 identity Act. The population commission's platform went live across all 36 states and the federal capital territory from 1 July 2026, the commission reporting about 57% of births currently registered — the first registration rate the base holds against the digital chain. A pilot in Gombe State trained personnel from 114 health facilities and 114 wards to capture births electronically and integrate registration with identity enrolment. The legal footing is the identity Act assented in June 2026, which makes the national identification number the foundational credential. No figure for identity numbers actually issued at birth registration is published.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	Interoperability of birth registration and digital id	Registration went nationwide on a digital platform from 1 July 2026, on a commission that states its system is interoperable with the identity commission. The platform is live across all 36 states and the federal capital territory from 1 July 2026, and the Gombe pilot was explicit about the link: personnel from 114 health facilities and 114 wards were trained to capture births electronically and integrate registration with identity enrolment. The commission's own statement puts the electronic civil registration system as interoperable with the identity commission and other identity agencies, and the 2026 identity Act strengthened the legal basis. No volume of records exchanged between the two is published.	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Use by other systems	A learner identification number was integrated with the identity register, farmer verification is planned on a subsidy taper, a credit bureau would key scores to the number, and pre-registered SIMs ended. A sixteen-digit learner number issued from April 2026 reached 1.9m at launch and was integrated with the identity register across a stated 80m student records; birth registration is integrated so newly registered children receive a number automatically, yet school admission remains manual and the birth register is not connected to any state education platform, so the failure is interoperability rather than enrolment. The integration was announced on a social platform rather than in an instrument, and it makes school enrolment an enrolment channel for the identity register (learners, gap). A centralised farmers database would target subsidies on a three-year taper and remove ghost beneficiaries (farmers), and a proposed bureau would tie credit scores to the number with consequences for defaulters extending to passport and licence renewal and tenancy (credit). Pre-registered cards ended in November 2025 (cards).	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Governance role of central bank	A Payments System Vision 2028 sets 95 per cent inclusion and a 70 per cent fraud cut from a ₦1.2 quadrillion baseline, alongside market-concentration caps, a foreign-exchange tracker and a second sandbox cohort. The vision runs a three-year horizon from 2025 baselines of ₦1.2 quadrillion in electronic transactions, 5.9m active terminals and 69.5m unique identifiers, targeting 95 per cent financial inclusion, full interoperability, adult digital-payment usage from about 52 to 80 per cent, 5m code-based merchant outlets and a 70 per cent reduction in fraud losses (vision, launch). Any institution above 25 per cent of consumer issuing may not exceed 15 per cent of merchant acquiring and the reverse, on monthly market-share returns with compliance by end-2026 (caps). Every licensed foreign-exchange bureau must report purchases in real time or same-day with banks as first line of enforcement (tracker); a second sandbox cohort opened to virtual-asset and data-enabled firms (sandbox); and the retail digital currency is being redesigned toward a wholesale model rather than abandoned (currency).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	G2P functionality	N6.6bn reached over 278,000 beneficiaries in one state while the digital currency's retail channel was withdrawn. The government disbursed N6.6 billion to over 278,000 Imo State beneficiaries drawn from the national social register, paid directly and linked to the national identification number, with the state moving from cash to direct bank-account payment — the first concrete disbursement figure the base holds on this indicator. A workshop in July 2026 validated business requirements for a unified government-to-person payment solution, a design-stage architecture rather than a live rail. Against that, the central bank digital currency whose 2021 guidelines defined government-to-person transaction types is being redesigned toward a wholesale model, withdrawing the retail leg those provisions describe.	MIXED the digital currency's retail leg was withdrawn while transfers ran through the social register and a unified rail entered design
Digital Payments and Fintech	Revenue collection	NGN 27.1 trillion was collected between January and July 2026, credited to digitised systems, with a treasury system deducting automatically and 7.5 per cent VAT on electronic banking fees. Collection ran at NGN 27.1 trillion between January and July 2026, an average NGN 127.83bn a day and 95.76 per cent of the whole of 2025's collection, which the revenue service credits to digitised tax systems, four reform laws and an executive order closing loopholes (collection); the attribution is the service's own and no counterfactual or system-level breakdown is published (collection). The treasury management and revenue assurance system automatically deducts and remits value-added tax, withholding tax and stamp duty on vendor payments across all agencies (treasury). Value-added tax of 7.5 per cent on electronic banking fees took effect in January 2026 (tax).	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	B2B and B2G functionality	Open banking was mandated from August 2025 across about 120m bank customers, a payments company gained direct card-network access without a bank sponsor, and embedded insurance opened to institutions. Open banking was the first in Africa, mandating consented customer-data sharing across about 120m bank customers through identifier-tied consent, a central registry and standardised interfaces, four years after the framework (open banking). A Nigerian payments company gained direct access to a global card network as a non-bank acquirer, letting it onboard licensed merchants without a bank sponsor; no merchant count, pricing or settlement arrangement is stated (access). Tier-one banks hold payments infrastructure inside the group rather than at arm's length, and the central bank has begun regulating fintech ownership as well as conduct (ownership); embedded insurance infrastructure opened to banks, fintechs, employers and merchants (insurance).	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	P2P, P2G and P2B functionality	Instant payments reached US\$256bn across 4.12bn transactions, a National Payment Stack carries 26.55m transactions on the new standard, and short-code billing settled a multi-year dispute. Electronic payments reached US\$256bn by July 2025 from US\$187bn a year earlier across 4.12bn transactions, and the instant system was rated the first African instant system to achieve mature inclusivity (payments, rating). The successor stack reports 26.55 million transactions worth ₦1.4 trillion across 48 institutions in its early phase, on a multi-currency platform carrying payments, identity and data together, with its first live transaction in November 2025 (stack, first transaction). Short-code session costs are billed to airtime at ₦6.98 per 120 seconds with real-time confirmation and opt-in, ending the multi-year operator and bank debt dispute (billing).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	Population uptake	Point-of-sale volumes fell 19.9 per cent as cash machine use rose, operator wallet revenue rose about 132 per cent, and formal inclusion stood at 64 per cent in 2023 against a 95 target. Cash machine transactions rose 6.6 per cent year on year in the first quarter of 2026 with value up 64.6 per cent, while point-of-sale volumes fell 19.9 per cent to 2.92bn under October 2025 agent-banking limits; the record carries no measure of what those limits did to access where there is no branch. Operator wallet revenue grew about 132 per cent in the first half of 2026, active wallets up 1.3m to 5m against a 30 million target. Retail investors traded ₦2.86tn of equities in five months, up 138.76 per cent, and a digital bank passed 30 million registered users in September 2026 on its own count - not an active or transacting figure. 2026-09-07 - the survey behind the inclusion figure is now held: formal inclusion reached 64 per cent of adults, about 71.7 million, in 2023 from 56 per cent in 2020, non-bank formal products moving 32 to 57 per cent, on 26,930 interviews across all 36 states and the federal capital territory, leaving about 28.9 million adults outside the formal system and the share counted financially healthy down to 16 per cent. Fieldwork ran August to October 2023, so the headline figure predates every payment-system change since.	MIXED wallet revenue and retail investing rising while point-of-sale volumes fell a fifth under new agent-banking limits
Digital Payments and Fintech	Cross-border functionality	Continental rail flows fell 53 per cent to about US\$3.7m in a half-year, while stablecoin settlement rails carry 1,500 businesses and a regulated naira stablecoin went live on a public blockchain. Flows on the continental rail fell 53 per cent to ₦5.6bn in the first half of 2025, about US\$3.7m, with transactions down 29 per cent to 3,246 - a narrow line item rather than national throughput. A wallet-based corridor to Ghana entered pilot. A licensed local exchange plugged into a dollar stablecoin's liquidity, reporting more than 1,500 businesses across two countries; the yield partners and rates are undisclosed (rails, settlement). The regulated naira stablecoin went live on a public blockchain in August 2026 backed one-to-one, with no supply, holder count or reserve attestation published (token, listing); remote diaspora bank onboarding launched in 2025 as remittances rose from US\$3.3bn to US\$4.73bn (diaspora). 2026-09-05 - the operator reports Nigeria-Rwanda volumes approaching and in places exceeding Nigeria-Ghana, and corridors with Cameroon, Niger and Benin growing on trade in Nigerian goods, with no volumes, values or period attached. 2026-09-06 - on the other direction of travel, diaspora inflows held steady at US\$21.8bn in 2025 on central bank figures, against an average cost of 8.46 per cent to send US\$200 to Sub-Saharan Africa and app-based rivals quoting 2-3 per cent on the London-Lagos corridor.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	Consumer protection	Fraud losses fell 51 per cent on a reporting rate down 34 per cent, the digital-lending regulations are under appeal, and about 40m airtime borrowers sit inside the jurisdiction dispute. Fraud losses fell to ₦25.85bn in 2025, down 51 per cent, on 67,518 incidents against 123,918 in 2021, with fraud reporting down 34 per cent in the fourth quarter (trust, challenge). The digital consumer-lending regulations were suspended by injunction, upheld in July 2026 and enforcement resumed, with an association's appeal before the Court of Appeal; the two regulators' positions are unreconciled, one holding airtime credit a telecommunications value-added service and the other framing the regulations as its answer to harassment and data breaches, and the communications minister has directed that the existing framework stays in place, an interim settlement by direction rather than by instrument (regulations, court, resumption). The product at the centre of it reaches about 40 million users on an industry sizing of ₦300-400bn a year, and one operator resumed at about a quarter of its first-quarter run rate at a stated cost of about ₦50bn to first-half revenue (airtime). A payment security operations centre is a 2028 target with no legal basis or funding line (centre), and a domestic cyber-insurance market is still forming (insurance).	MIXED fraud losses halved on a falling reporting rate while a digital-lending regime went to appeal and forty million airtime borrowers sat between two regulators
Registries	Population register	A diaspora health-workforce registry was launched standing on no stated legal basis. It is described as newly launched, with no launch date, custodian agency, enrolment terms or data-protection basis stated in anything held: a register standing up ahead of its governance (registry). It is the pattern this unit repeats across the mortgage registry, the cooperative credential and the addressing framework, each announced before the instrument that would govern it.	ADVANCED
Registries	Civil register	Paper registration was discontinued from July 2026, but none of 371 targeted health facilities is live, 120,469 certificates were issued against 443,162 registrations, and the platform showed charges for documents stated to be free. Registration went nationwide on a single platform through 4,011 centres toward a target of about 8,000, with newborn registration requiring at least one parent to hold a valid identity number and the register run as a public-private partnership (platform, state). It has stalled at the health-facility layer: none of 371 targeted facilities is live despite completed training, zero birth notifications were recorded in the reporting year, 120,469 certificates were issued against 443,162 registrations, and an estimated 3.5 million children across seven southern states hold no certificate (gap). The platform displayed charges of US\$30 to US\$80 for documents the commission says are free, and carried one man's record with a wife and a son unknown to him until the commission corrected it free of charge the day after publication (corrections, records).	MIXED paper registration discontinued nationwide while the health-facility layer recorded zero birth notifications
Registries	Address register	A national alphanumeric postcode has a launch date of 1 October 2026, and the addressing council ratified a framework replacing the 2017 policy. The postcode is explicitly property-level rather than cluster-level, with integration to existing government identity databases to follow; no lawful basis, custodian or data-protection arrangement for that integration is stated (postcode). The council, chaired by the Vice-President, ratified a preliminary framework naming the science ministry as secretariat and assigning individual verification to the identity commission, business address verification to the corporate registry, postcode administration to the postal service and implementation to states; it would replace a 2017 standard described as obsolete, focused on mail delivery and silent on business address verification (framework, standard). A state is separately piloting digital house-numbering (pilot).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Business register	A beneficial ownership register launched in 2023 is in use by enforcement agencies, alongside a national electronic assets register live since March 2025. The electronic assets register went live in March 2025; no asset count, agency coverage or update cycle is published. The beneficial ownership register, launched in 2023, is open to government institutions, civil society, journalists and citizens, and regulatory and enforcement agencies are using it for transparency, enforcement and asset recovery; it is named as contributing to Nigeria's exit from the Financial Action Task Force grey list. Compliance by legacy companies and digitisation of the corporate registry's records remain outstanding. Business registration itself reaches the base only through the centralised service gateway that offers it as one of several services.	ADVANCED
Registries	Social protection register	The national social register expanded to 19.7m households from 13m, using artificial intelligence, satellite imagery and telecoms data to find urban-slum households. The expansion used artificial intelligence, satellite imagery and telecoms data to reach households the register had missed, and 74 per cent of prison inmates hold an identity number (register). No exclusion, appeal or error measure for the register is published, and finding households by satellite and call-detail inference is a targeting method the data-protection regime does not separately address.	ADVANCED
Registries	Electoral register	Biometric voter accreditation devices failed at a state governorship election, with two observer missions calling for a technical audit before the 2027 general election. The bar association's election working group recorded devices failing to boot and delaying a poll's opening, fingerprint and facial capture failing on some voters — elderly voters recurrently — so that they could not vote at all, slow processing at units of over 1,100 registered voters, an export failure and a complete device stoppage at one unit (report). It recommends comprehensive pre-election testing of biometric capture, network connectivity, battery performance and volume handling, and an upgrade before the general election (upgrade); a second observer mission separately called for a full post-election technical audit (audit). No commission response, failure rate or audit commitment is on record, and the observations are limited to the units the teams visited.	REGRESSED
Registries	Tax register	A central tax identification portal went live on 1 January 2026, linking tax identifiers to the national identification number. The portal went live nationwide on 1 January 2026, run jointly by the revenue board and the revenue service, linking tax identifiers to the national identification number for individuals and to corporate registration numbers for businesses, and replacing previously issued taxpayer identification numbers. The revenue service briefed federal bodies in July 2026 on the platform that replaced its predecessor and consolidates taxpayer registration, returns filing, payment and communications on one system. The statutory duty is the Tax Administration Act 2025. No register size, coverage figure or registration outturn is published under any of them.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Land register	More than 90 per cent of land is unregistered, locking an estimated US\$300bn as dead capital, while a mortgage registry is described as ready for deployment. The national land registration and documentation programme is under way against more than 90 per cent of land unregistered, on the housing minister's figure (programme). A national mortgage registry is described as ready for deployment with no launch date, custodian arrangement or data-protection basis stated, and its governing policy is still a draft under stakeholder validation (registry). One state has a live compensation and valuation land system (state system).	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Health	A Nigeria Digital Health Architecture is named as the integration target of a United States health memorandum carrying US\$196m for health data systems. Health information, health services and health insurance claims exchanges are named as the integration target (architecture, memorandum). US\$196,000,000 of United States funding is planned for health data systems over 2026 to 2030 (funding). The architecture is named in a foreign instrument the government signed, and no Nigerian document setting it out is held.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Education	A nationwide learner identification number launched in April 2026 on the school register, with a credential repository alongside it. The launch of 9 April 2026 issued a permanent per-learner identity built on the national school register, its first phase giving ten-digit identifiers to over 1.9 million candidates for the 2026 school examinations. The repository deployed in March 2026 integrates more than 250 tertiary institutions for real-time credential verification. Both rest on the policy signed in August 2021 establishing the national, state and local education management information systems. No enrolment coverage or data-quality figure for the school register is published.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Social protection	A unified poverty response architecture was flagged off in March 2026, above transfers of ₦33.75bn the Auditor-General could not verify reached beneficiaries. The architecture flagged off on 25 March 2026 sets out a unified national register, a poverty exit pathway and a poverty intelligence lab to replace the fragmented humanitarian and social-protection data systems. A validation workshop in July 2026 took the business requirements for a unified government-to-person payment rail under that framework to the vice-president's office, the social investment agency, the central bank, the interbank settlement system and the government network provider. The operating base underneath is unchanged: the social register at 19.7 million households and the safety-net programme's identity validation and fully digital payments. Neither the architecture nor the payment rail is reported operating. 2026-09-07 - the delivery end of the same architecture failed its audit. The Auditor-General's 2024 report states that the government could not provide sufficient evidence that ₦33.75bn of cash transfers intended for more than 3,295,207 vulnerable households reached genuine beneficiaries, the payment platform's statements not having been supplied, and a civil-society organisation puts over ₦78.8bn across social protection programmes as diverted, unaccounted for or irregularly spent. The audit report itself is not held, and no response from the agencies named is on file.	MIXED a unified architecture is being designed above transfers the state auditor could not verify reached anyone

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Justice	Electronic filing became compulsory at the Supreme Court from July 2026, behind a national case management system, with no judicial technology strategy to stop courts adopting incompatible systems. Practice directions make electronic upload of processes and records of appeal compulsory, searchable and on standardised naming, inside a wider registry programme covering online senior-advocate applications, digital enrolment of practitioners, electronic registration of notaries and an electronic diary (directions). A former state attorney-general argues the value is operations management rather than digitisation and calls for a national judicial technology strategy under the judicial council to stop each court adopting incompatible systems; no such strategy is held.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Tax	Two 2025 tax statutes underpin a virtual-asset tax framework withholding 1.5 per cent in the asset itself, and a state is testing withholding on creator payouts. The two 2025 statutes are the base for the virtual-asset circular and for tying crypto trades to tax and identity numbers (statutes). The circular imposes a 1.5 per cent stamp duty withheld in the asset itself and remitted in the originating token, so the federal government now holds token receipts and the price risk on its own tax revenue, alongside withholding on disposal proceeds, on staking and yield, value-added tax on service fees and companies income tax (framework); traders warned the charge could push activity into unregulated channels, and a true wallet-to-wallet trade has no collection agent at all (framework, objections). A state revenue service is testing whether creator-economy platform payouts are royalties subject to 5 per cent withholding and pressing two platforms to deduct at source (creators); no assessment, ruling or judgment is published (creators).	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Customs	Electronic cargo tracking replaced physical escort at a second command, and the National Single Window published its first throughput figures alongside a November 2026 deadline for agencies to complete phase two. Satellite tracking replaced physical escort of transit cargo at a second pilot command (tracking). The single window's first published throughput (deadline) puts it at more than 124,614 licences and permits processed, 11,096 importers and agents registered and about N12.59bn in regulatory payments facilitated since 27 March 2026, with five agencies fully onboarded, 25 of 27 air-cargo airlines and 48 of 88 shipping lines joined. Ministries, departments and agencies have until the end of November 2026 to complete a phase two integrating export permits, certificates, licences, inspections and payments into a single submission (deadline). Licensed customs agents contest the platform in operation, saying clearance paperwork has multiplied rather than consolidated and calling for the customs service to take over implementation outright; no clearance-time figure is published against which either account can be tested (dispute).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Land	A national land registration programme moved to rollout, and one state launched a working land information service. The housing ministry announced national rollout in August 2025, targeting 18 to 20 reform-ready states, over a million digital titles and standardised interoperable land information and mapping systems — a move from the March 2025 position, which was a plan with no build stage. Kwara State launched its own geographic land information service on 20 October 2025, with online certificate-of-occupancy applications and payments, over 1,000 scanned layouts and about 20,000 digitised plots — the first operating digital land system the base holds. The national system the housing minister said did not exist in March 2025 still has no published build stage, budget, operator or launch date.	ADVANCED
Other GovTech and e-Gov	e-government services	A single sign-on gateway is in pilot, a centralised service gateway launched in August 2026, and neither states its relationship to the other. The sign-on gateway is piloting on a four-year foreign-funded project reported at US\$13m inside an electronic-government master plan (gateway); the load-bearing feature is the once-only data exchange behind the login rather than the portal itself (gateway, platform). A centralised gateway launched in August 2026 as a single point of access to federal services previously spread across agency websites, stated as a defence against fraudulent look-alike sites; no service count, transaction volume, cost or build attribution is published, and no relationship is stated to the sign-on gateway that soft-launched a month earlier (services). A central bank document-flow and payment solution has been live since January 2025 (documents), and the technology agency agreed to digitise pilgrimage operations end to end with no scope document, budget or timetable published (pilgrimage). A third platform was approved in the same period and sits outside both gateways: a smart national transport data bank, approved by the Federal Executive Council on a design-build-finance-operate-and-transfer model, to hold a nationwide central database of drivers, vehicles, number plates and operators and to standardise motor-park manifests (approval). No cost, concession term or data-custody arrangement is disclosed for it.	ADVANCED

Digitalisation

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	ICT infrastructure for local government	A state services platform entered a second phase, a state artificial-intelligence programme is constrained by connectivity, and a foreign-funded state reform project launched. The state platform is expanding to digitise services and formalise small enterprises, logging about 14,000 visits over three weeks in July despite limited publicity (platform); visits are not registrations or transactions and no service count, formalisation figure or cost is stated (platform, partnership). A state push on artificial intelligence and paperless government is constrained by weak connectivity and computing capacity on its own agency's account, with no budget, procurement, delivery date or named system published (programme, plan). A foreign development project will produce a digital-economy strategy, an infrastructure roadmap, a civic-technology strategy and a connectivity-reform framework for one state, with value and duration not stated (project); another state activated a multi-gigabit airport backbone (airport). Lagos State says it laid about 3,000km of a planned 6,000km unified fibre network between 2019 and 2025 and plans to secure 200-400MW of state-procured electricity; the figures are the state's own, with no route, cost or independent verification published (state network).	ADVANCED
Digitalisation of sub-national government	Digitalisation of local government records	A state artificial-intelligence platform flagged ₦2.1bn unspent and detected ghost workers, an open-contracting platform runs in three states, and a state trade programme opened to 1,000 firms. The state platform flagged a ₦2.1bn unspent education allocation and detected ghost workers through identity and bank-number cross-checks; the technology agency says under 10 per cent of government operations nationwide are digitised (platform). An artificial-intelligence open-contracting platform has run in three states since February 2025 (contracting). A state programme offers free digital storefronts, registration support, digital-trade training and payment enablement to 1,000 small firms, with cost, funder and selection method unstated (trade). Ondo State launched a payroll and human-resources platform for its civil service on 4 September 2026, bringing employee records, salary computation, approvals, payroll and pension migration into one environment with bank-verification-number integration intended to remove duplicate records and unauthorised payments; no cost, vendor or headcount is published (platform).	ADVANCED
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural health clinics	Digital vaccine-stock reporting reached 13,634 facilities, the first facility count the base holds for the primary health layer. The primary health care agency's nationwide rollout of digital vaccine-stock reporting reached 13,634 facilities — the largest documented movement in the window and the first time the base holds a facility count rather than a description. A digital clinical decision tool for rural community health practitioners launched on 25 October 2025 and is to be mandatory from 2027. Both sit above the agency's data-aggregation hub for primary health centre data, which remains an institutional description with no coverage figure of its own.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural primary schools	A state's 260 smart green schools at about ₦1.3-1.5bn each were promised open by January 2026 and many were incomplete, with roofs failed at three sites. The programme covers 260 schools, one in each ward, powered by solar and connected by satellite, at about ₦1.3-1.5bn per school from state allocations of ₦266.7bn in 2025 and ₦198bn in 2026 (investigation). Full opening of all 260 was promised for January 2026; as of May many were incomplete and unequipped with pupils already resuming, roofs had failed at three sites, one school was demolished after failing integrity tests, and a ₦11.4bn contract for 22 schools was terminated with ₦1.23bn recovered.	STALLED
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural registry offices	Registration went live across all 36 states and the federal capital from 1 July 2026, while none of 371 targeted health facilities went live. The population commission's platform is live across all 36 states and the federal capital territory from 1 July 2026, with about 57% of births currently registered; it announced the nationwide commencement on 15 July 2026. Against that, paper registration was discontinued from 1 July 2026 but none of 371 targeted health facilities were live despite completed training, and zero birth notifications were flowing from them — the layer that would reach births outside registry offices. A pilot in Gombe State trained personnel from 114 health facilities and 114 wards to capture births electronically and link them to identity enrolment, which is the model the national layer has not reproduced.	MIXED the registry went nationwide on a digital platform while the health-facility notification layer did not start
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural police stations	The first Smart Police Station launched in Gombe State in June 2026, under a memorandum to map and connect stations nationwide. The government network provider and the police trust fund launched the first Smart Police Station, in Gombe State, on 11 June 2026. It follows the memorandum of 23 April 2026 to map and fibre-connect police stations nationwide, rural stations included, with digital reporting tools. Underneath, the interior ministry's national criminal data fusion centre describes biometric capture at divisional stations. One station is not a rollout: no count of connected stations, and no timetable against the memorandum, is published.	ADVANCED

Technology

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Use of AI in government administration	A generative assistant runs across the federal civil service, a public-services chatbot answers in four languages, and a state automated its own agency operations on an open model. The civil-service assistant has been in service since February 2025 (assistant). The public-services chatbot runs on an open foundation model in English and three Nigerian languages, pitched at rural, low-literacy and multilingual users, though poor rural broadband limits reach (chatbot). A state technology agency reports modifying and training an open-source model to automate its own operations end to end and says it is exploring replication across state government; the account is the agency's own and no model, evaluation or measured saving is published (automation). A state survivor-support chatbot has been live since February 2025 (survivor support).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Use of AI in sectoral management information systems	Fraud detection was made mandatory in June 2026, 87.5 per cent of surveyed fintechs already use it, and one firm scores the unbanked from payment traces and sells the output to lenders. Artificial-intelligence and machine-learning fraud detection was made mandatory in June 2026 (mandate). A responsible artificial-intelligence in finance hub is proposed over an installed base: 87.5 per cent of the fintechs the central bank surveyed already use the technology for fraud detection, so production use is at near-saturation in a licensed sector under no national instrument and no model-risk rule (hub). One firm builds credit scores for people without bank accounts by reading payment traces, and sells the output to lenders; there is no published model-risk rule, no accuracy or adverse-impact measure and no route for a person to contest a score built this way (scoring).	ADVANCED
AI	Development of national / regional AI systems	A sovereign multilingual model covers four Nigerian languages, a code-switching speech model follows speakers who change language mid-sentence, and an analysis agent is distributed through universities. The sovereign model is open-source and multimodal across three Nigerian languages and Nigerian-accented English, built on an open foundation model and fine-tuned on more than 400m tokens; the country has more than 500 native languages (model). A domestically built speech model was released to follow African speakers who switch languages mid-sentence, where most recognition systems transcribe the English and drop the other language; no accuracy benchmark against a named baseline, language list or deployment figure is published (speech). A spreadsheet-analysis agent is distributed through universities, co-working spaces and professional communities, its first partner bundling premium credits into member subscriptions; the governance point is that the co-working operator becomes the party mediating which tools its members meet and on what data terms (agent).	ADVANCED
AI	Control of AI abuse	An above US\$470m surveillance estate is the continent's largest with little evidence it reduces crime, and a state facial-recognition network was approved with no lawful basis stated. A research mapping puts spend on facial recognition and number-plate tracking above US\$470m with about 10,000 smart cameras, and researchers found little evidence it reduces crime and minimal use of footage in prosecutions (estate). A state approved a first phase specified after engagements with a Chinese vendor, carrying facial recognition, plate recognition and violence detection across intersections, government precincts, coastal communities and a highway, feeding a command centre in the state security adviser's office; the claimed gains are emergency response falling from over 45 minutes to under 12, and no lawful basis, retention rule or oversight arrangement for the face and plate data is stated anywhere in the announcement (network). A maritime surveillance system built for the navy is being pitched inland for banditry, with neither funding nor a political decision behind it, and its claimed returns are the vendor's own (maritime). A concessioned transport databank would put at least 250 gantries carrying plate recognition on the roads with traffic centres in every state (databank). The transport ministry inaugurated the concession committee in August 2026: a second plate-recognition estate, again with no lawful basis, retention rule or oversight arrangement stated.	REGRESSED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
ICT Industry	National capacity in DT-related production	Telecommunications reached 9.19 per cent of GDP, the country-code domain passed 300,000 registrations, and the tower estate was consolidated under a single owner. Telecommunications and information services reached 9.19 per cent of real GDP in the first quarter of 2026, a post-rebasing high, within information and communication at 11.31 per cent (share); a chamber of commerce figure of 10.07 per cent matches no official series, and the minister's tracking-close-to-21-per-cent claim is roughly double the official share and supported by no series the base holds, so it is recorded as a ministerial claim (share). The country-code domain passed 300,000 registrations in 2025 (domain), and 13,500 towers moved to a single infrastructure owner in a 2025 consolidation (towers). An operator has run domestic spam detection since March 2025 (spam), and a publication calculates about US\$41m due to the state from a US\$406m operator dividend, with no government confirmation of receipt held (dividend).	ADVANCED
Innovation ecosystem	Technology hubs	The regulator leased two federal facilities to a state after failing to activate them, a digital free zone runs remote incorporation, and ten state hubs are planned. The regulator built buildings for outsourcing, incubation and skills and could not activate them, its executive vice chairman saying buildings alone do not create innovation, and leased them to the state for fifteen years to run as a talent city and an artificial-intelligence institute; both parties call the transfer temporary and reversible, and no rent, investment commitment or performance condition is stated (lease). The digital free zone is live for remote incorporation on a US\$100m first-phase commitment from a continental financier (zone). Ten state hubs are planned alongside the national talent programme (hubs), and a defence-technology firm holding a joint venture with the state arms corporation is to build robotics, drone and virtual-reality laboratories at a private university, with lab count, cost, funding, intake, research ownership and dual-use vetting all unstated (laboratories).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Innovation ecosystem	Tech startup ecosystem	A drive-to-own vehicle financier reached a US\$2.1bn valuation on a 42,000-vehicle fleet, a diaspora remittance product was wound down, and the largest payments processor folded in a third acquired brand. About 25,000 small and medium enterprises are to receive N20bn in software credits under a vendor partnership with the small-business development agency (announcement). The credits are vendor-funded and the base holds no take-up figure. The financier was founded in Nigeria in 2020 and is now headquartered in Dubai, raising US\$250m at a US\$2.1bn valuation against a 42,000-vehicle fleet across fourteen countries (valuation); the drive-to-own model makes ride-hailing platform earnings the credit-scoring and repayment rail for drivers outside formal banking, and no Nigerian instrument addresses that class of alternative-data underwriting (valuation, round, series). A Nigerian group is phasing out its United Kingdom diaspora remittance product less than eighteen months after launch, redirecting resources to Nigeria and Kenya, having committed 1.2 million pounds in setup expenditure and placed a US\$2.5m equity deposit in July 2025 against US\$7.39m earmarked in filings (wind-down). A crowdsourced food-price platform reached about 2,500 users and extended into direct farmer-to-consumer sales (prices). The largest payments processor is winding down a card-issuing fintech acquired in an unannounced 2025 deal, closing its accounts on 1 December with balances and transaction history not carrying over — the third brand folded in. No deal value is disclosed for any of them.	ADVANCED

Capacity

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	Digital literacy (civil service)	One state trained 40,000 civil servants, and a data-protection officer pipeline targets 250,000 certifications a year in a sector that is 65 per cent of employment. Forty thousand state civil servants were trained by March 2025 (state training). The officer pipeline targets 250,000 certified officers a year aimed at the informal sector, which is 65 per cent of employment and 58 per cent of gross domestic product, and the data-protection industry created 23,000 jobs in 2024 (pipeline, academy). The federal circular now requires every agency to appoint qualified officers, so the pipeline and the obligation arrived in the same period; no count of officers actually appointed across the federal service is published.	ADVANCED
Literacy	Digital literacy (general population)	A second consecutive year of free student artificial-intelligence subscriptions runs alongside a US\$1m commitment to train a million people that drew feasibility scepticism at US\$1 a trainee. From August 2026 students at accredited universities, polytechnics and colleges of education get twelve months of a paid artificial-intelligence tier free, worth ₦92,400, the second consecutive year of the offer and one of 27 sub-Saharan rollouts, inside a five-area alliance running since February 2025 that put ₦3bn into Nigeria across five partners (students, alliance, training). A US\$1m commitment to train a million people over two years works out at US\$1 a trainee, a ratio that drew feasibility scepticism (commitment). A federal facility leased to a state is to run as a talent city and artificial-intelligence institute, with no capacity, occupancy or programme figure published (talent city).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Training and skills	DT-related training in secondary education	A technical education digital strategy was validated, about 11,700 teachers are contracted for artificial-intelligence training, and seventy teachers from 40 schools took a state programme. The technical and vocational strategy was validated in August 2026 (strategy). A teacher capacity programme was contracted for national rollout to about 11,700 teachers across all federal unity colleges on the strength of a pilot in six colleges whose claimed results rest on the implementer's own account with no published evaluation (teachers); neither the contract value, the funding source, the training duration nor the selection route for the contractor is stated (teachers). A state programme took seventy teachers drawn from 40 public schools, entering the classroom through teachers rather than the curriculum (state). 2026-08-31 – the technology development agency closed the 2026 edition of a school-holiday coding bootcamp in Kano, Kwara, Jigawa and Gombe, teaching coding, computational thinking and digital creativity, and states the same training continues in three southern zones. No participant count, cost, partner list or curriculum is published, and the base holds no earlier edition against which to read it.	ADVANCED
Training and skills	DT-related university facilities and qualifications	US\$1.1m funds a train-the-trainer curriculum at ten universities, a national diploma in artificial intelligence launched for polytechnics, and a university cybersecurity centre is operating. The upskilling grant funds a train-the-trainer curriculum at ten Nigerian universities with a continental mathematical sciences institute; the country is the first of four, and the programme states 30 institutions across four countries and a target of more than 30,000 students, neither separately dated nor funded in the record (grant, programme). A national diploma curriculum in artificial intelligence launched for polytechnics, and the board reports the technology has cut its own curriculum-development costs by about 50 per cent by generating draft curricula and courseware (diploma). A university cybersecurity centre has operated since May 2025 (centre), and a training-of-trainers cohort was followed by a startup academy after 3,856 applications, with no cohort size, cost or completion figure published for either (trainers).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Training and skills	Graduates entering DT ecosystem	The three-million talent programme reports 1.87m registrations and more than 135,000 trained across three cohorts, a figure unmoved since January 2026. Registrations run at 1.87m across all 774 local government areas with more than 135,000 trained across three cohorts and 15,000 job pathways created, against a target of information technology reaching 22 per cent of gross domestic product by 2027 (programme); the figures are the organisers' own and no independent evaluation is held (programme, commitment). The trained count is unmoved since at least January 2026, which is a stale-boilerplate flag rather than evidence of a higher count, and the programme has never stated whether it counts completion or enrolment. A ministerial figure of nearly 300,000 is the programme's own separate community-reach category, not a rival trained count (placement). A free state academy targets 10,000 young people and 100 certified trainers (academy), two foundation programmes opened 2026 applications with no cohort size or placement figure published (applications), and a private student aid scheme of 50 million naira opened for a single round (aid). 2026-08-24 — a foundation-funded digital-skills programme began delivery with its first orientation at a Kano polytechnic, its delivery partner stating it runs across ten states with three northern locations. No cohort size, completion rate or placement figure is published.	ADVANCED
Research institutions	Think tanks and academic departments contributing to DT policy	An education-technology fellowship has supported 72 companies since 2019, and its fourth cohort funds education and workforce data systems in their own right. The eighteen-month accelerator offers each company up to US\$100,000 in equity-free funding and structured technical assistance, with twelve startups in cohort four and 72 companies supported since 2019 (fellowship); the intake is targeted rather than open, across learners with disabilities, displacement-affected and rural communities, girls and young women, and education and workforce data systems, the fourth category funding sectoral education data infrastructure in its own right. The reach figure of more than 700,000 new learners is the hub's own (fellowship). A vendor-run academy sits inside a government skills initiative with a startup pitch competition and a developer bootcamp, its prize partly denominated in the sponsor's own advertising credits and no cohort size, curriculum or cost published (academy); a talent-export platform partnership has run since April 2025 (export).	ADVANCED

Inclusion

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Citizen feedback portals	Two new complaint channels opened in 2026: an electronic grievance platform inside the presidency and a tax ombud portal. The presidency's service-compliance office launched a World Bank-backed electronic grievance management platform on 5 March 2026, a second channel alongside the portal it opened in 2025. The tax ombud launched a website, call centre and case-management portal on 19 May 2026, with complaint tracking, for taxpayers specifically. The 2025 citizens e-feedback portal is unchanged. No complaint volume, resolution rate or agency-coverage figure is published for any of the three, so what moved is the number of channels and not their use.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Citizen participation in policy	A fourth open government action plan was published in April 2026 days before the third was reported as failing its budget commitments. The plan published on 17 April 2026 is a youth-shaped twelve-commitment framework covering digital governance and citizen participation. The National Assembly declared an Open Week on 15 July 2026, a legislative-branch engagement event distinct from the executive-led plan. Against those, the independent reporting mechanism's final report of 28 April 2026 names the open-budget commitments among those that did not achieve their intended results, and records co-creation concentrated in Abuja and Lagos, with logistics costs and accessibility barriers limiting it elsewhere. The new plan carries no successor budget-participation commitment the base can point to.	MIXED the 2023-2025 plan's budget commitments failed while a fourth action plan and a parliamentary open week arrived
Access to services	Gender equity	A digital self-care platform went live for university students, routing to free contraceptives through the state health supply chain with discreet delivery. The platform is live for students at one university and routes to free contraceptives via the state health ministry and an agency supply chain, with discreet delivery and pharmacist support, and expansion to other campuses planned (platform). No user count, uptake figure or data-protection arrangement for reproductive-health requests is published, which is the sensitive-category question the country's own Act would reach.	ADVANCED
Access to services	Inclusion of persons with disabilities	A four-and-a-half-year programme for young people with disabilities opened in Lagos, while none of eight public websites audited in May 2026 met baseline accessibility. The programme is run by a disability-rights organisation with a philanthropic foundation to expand employment access through digital skills, entrepreneurship and inclusive employment pathways, opened with the state disability office's stated support (programme). No budget, participant target or state-government commitment beyond stated support is published. It is the only disability-specific digital programme in the base for the country. 2026-08-31 — none of eight public websites audited in May 2026, among them the admissions board, the identity commission, the revenue service and the disability commission itself, had baseline accessibility features. An earlier assessment of all 36 states and the Federal Capital Territory found 26 non-compliant with the agency's website guidelines and 14 sites unusable for people with disabilities — different samples, not a series. The guidelines are in force and the web design standards meant to make them buildable published no toolkit a year on, while the regulator ran a fourth assistive-technology hackathon in Abuja on 26 and 27 August 2026 — the assistive half of the problem, not the accessibility half. An estimated 35 million Nigerians are persons with disabilities.	MIXED a disability-specific programme opened while the accessibility standard stalled and no audited public website met a baseline

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Inclusion of refugees and IDPs	A statute domesticating the African Union displacement convention was assented in March 2026, and a \$300 million programme was announced. The President assented on 9 March 2026 to the Act domesticating and enforcing the African Union convention on internally displaced persons, a distinct statute from the 2022 commission Act. A \$300 million World Bank-financed programme for displaced people and host communities was announced on 16 July 2026, framed as a move from humanitarian relief to development-linked inclusion. The commission's own statutory registry function is unchanged: the 2022 Act requires it to register and personally document persons of concern and to support states in maintaining registers. No registration, identification or service-access figure under any of the three is published.	ADVANCED
Digital divides	Bridging of digital divides	23 per cent of rural communities have internet against 57 urban, zero-rated education access would require registration, and rural job centres are at equipment tender. Rural internet reaches 23 per cent of communities against 57 per cent urban (rural); the universal service fund plans 1,000 new rural base stations by 2030 and the minister told the President that about 3,700 towers start deploying around October 2026 targeting more than 20m people in communities with no service at all, with capital raised and no funding source, operator or contract named (rural, stations, towers). Every eligibility option consulted on for zero-rated education access requires registration to control access and prevent abuse, the monitoring set includes tunnelling and streaming of non-educational content, and the regulator says on the record the scheme may breach net neutrality (zero rating). Equipment for rural job centres in two states is out to tender under a foreign-funded youth-employment project, fixing the equipment stage and nothing about the centres (centres); agent-network microfinance reaches microenterprises through trained local agents with no published coverage figures (microfinance).	MIXED 3,700 towers contracted for unserved communities while only 23 per cent of rural communities have internet and zero-rating would require registration to use

Data

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	National strategy for development of statistics	The third statistical strategy was issued in December 2025 and the statistician-general committed to implementing it. The government issued the strategy on 15 December 2025 alongside a national data action plan and a review of the sustainable development goals — a dated launch event distinct from the catalogue record the base had held. The statistician-general's 2026 new year message commits to implementing its reforms; the page gives no exact day. The strategy text itself is still held only as a catalogue record, and no implementation report, funding line or mid-term review is published against it.	ADVANCED
National statistics	Censuses and surveys	A first biometric census remains planned with a budget of about ₦980bn under review, and the last census was 2006. A committee will review the roughly ₦980bn budget, and no date has been set (census). Twenty years without a census is the baseline against which every population-denominated figure in this report has to be read. An inclusive-data initiative widened from three countries to five in July 2026, putting the national statistics office into the programme (initiative).	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	Statistics from administrative data	A health sector review compiled from routine administrative records reported in November 2025, and two ministries agreed a central government data repository. The 2025 health sector joint annual review tracks indicators compiled from routine health-sector administrative records and put implementation of the health compact at 84% — the clearest case in the base of administrative data driving a published performance assessment. The finance and budget ministries agreed on 2 September 2026 to create a central government data repository and a standing committee on macroeconomic data, after a validation workshop found significant gaps between past budget assumptions and outcomes, particularly for oil production and revenue (repository); no host institution, membership or commencement date is stated. The legal base remains the Statistics Act 2007.	ADVANCED
Open data	Use of open data	A 2018 open data policy is still the operative framework, while the open contracting portal is the one national dataset assessed as in use. The open data policy issued in July 2018 remains the only national instrument expressly titled one, and no revision, review or compliance report under it is held; a national data action plan for 2025 to 2028 was launched above it in December 2025. The data exchange was launched at a stakeholder workshop in August 2025 explicitly framed as enabling anonymised public-data use, and the public portal of the national education management platform is the first opening of a national administrative dataset to the public the base records; no dataset list, licence or update cadence is published for either. The open contracting portal publishes standardised procurement data with dashboards, and the procurement bureau reports about N173bn of savings in the first half of 2025 — the only case in the base where published data is assessed against an outcome.	ADVANCED
Use of satellite data	Agricultural use of satellite data	A vendor is in exploratory talks on artificial intelligence for smallholder farmers, with no programme, funding, timeline or counterparty ministry named. The talks were reported in July 2026 and nothing beyond them is on record (talks). The farmer database planned for subsidy targeting is keyed to the identity register rather than to earth-observation data, so the base holds no operational agricultural use of satellite data for this country.	ADVANCED
Use of satellite data	Meteorological use of satellite data	A climate data initiative launched in August 2025 puts satellite data alongside ground observations on the agency's own portal. The initiative launched on 19 August 2025 with a regional research institute and philanthropic funding integrates satellite data with ground observations through the meteorological agency's Maproom portal. The agency also implemented a centralised interface for satellite-derived aviation weather data, replacing per-user access to the international service; the page carries no dateline and the month is inferred from the site's own identifier sequence. Both sit on the Meteosat receiving station installed in May 2025. No data volume, product list or downstream user figure is published for any of them.	ADVANCED

Geopolitics

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
US / hyperscaler activities	USA / hyperscaler MoUs, engagements and commitments	A hyperscaler began billing in naira, a carrier-neutral facility opened, a card network built a data centre, and a trade agency funded cloud-adoption training at a Nigerian bank. Naira billing began in January 2026, removing the foreign-exchange step from cloud spending (billing); a carrier-neutral facility opened in Lagos in June 2025 (facility) and a card network built its own data centre in November 2025 (card centre). A United States trade and development agency training grant to a Nigerian commercial bank supports its adoption of an American hyperscale cloud platform, funding training for senior managers on cloud governance and financial management; the grant amount is not stated, and the award moves a bank's workloads toward the foreign public cloud the base separately measures dependence on (grant). A US\$2m grant supports the 90,000 km fibre build alongside a feasibility grant for backbone reaching 12m people (fibre, feasibility).	ADVANCED
China activities	Chinese MoUs, engagements and commitments	A vendor innovation centre was framed by the minister as a catalyst for technology sovereignty, a vendor academy sits inside the teacher-training accreditor, and an agentic AI cloud launched locally in August 2026. The Lagos innovation centre opened in May 2025 and was framed by the minister as a catalyst for the country's technology sovereignty, an unusually sovereignty-coded reception for a Chinese vendor (centre). The academy sits at the commission itself and runs continuous training for lecturers and students, with the college curriculum revised to add artificial intelligence and robotics, networking and cybersecurity, data science and software development; no term, value or deliverable is published, so a single vendor's certification track is being written into the qualification route for the teachers who will go on to teach it (academy). 2026-08-27 — the vendor launched an agentic artificial-intelligence cloud on its local infrastructure at its own Lagos summit, offered with data residency, security, compliance and low-latency claims for finance, telecommunications, internet services, government and enterprise. The technology development agency framed it against the National Sovereign Cloud Initiative and its ambition to move the country from consuming technology to hosting it — sovereignty language again attached to a foreign vendor's platform. No customer, contract, capacity or price is stated, and the residency claims are the vendor's own.	ADVANCED
EU activities	EU MoUs, engagements and commitments	A EUR 820m digital envelope was stated at a workshop, a EUR 45m package was signed in 2025, and a Danish case-management platform is deployed across federal ministries. The envelope was stated at a framework validation workshop rather than in an instrument, alongside a national innovation hub standards framework that is validated rather than adopted (envelope, gateway). A digital economy package of EUR 45m was signed in December 2025 (package). The case-management platform is deployed with a Nigerian provider across federal ministries on the assurance that all sovereign data remains in Nigeria (platform). A cyber and digitalisation memorandum was signed with Finland in March 2026 (cyber), and Sweden signed a connectivity memorandum (connectivity).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Gulf/UAE activities	Gulf MoUs, engagements and commitments	A five-year defence memorandum with Saudi Arabia and a ports and digital trade memorandum followed the Emirati partnership agreement. The comprehensive economic partnership agreement with the United Arab Emirates was signed on 13 January 2026; its text is not held and no digital chapter is published. A five-year defence and military cooperation memorandum with Saudi Arabia was signed on 9 December 2025, and an Emirati ports operator signed a memorandum with the transport ministry on 19 January 2026 covering ports, logistics, maritime and digital trade infrastructure. Three instruments in fourteen months is the movement; what any of them carries for the digital economy is unestablished, since no text is held for any.	ADVANCED
India activities	India MoUs, engagements and commitments	A \$1 billion steel-sector memorandum was signed in April 2026, after a defence-industrial bilateral meeting. A \$1 billion steel-sector memorandum was signed at Kolkata on 14 April 2026, the first dated commercial commitment the base holds since the 2024 state visit. It followed a defence-industrial bilateral meeting in New Delhi on 12 August 2025 advancing cooperation on equipment and joint research. The digital thread is still the older one: the 2024 joint statement names cyber security, fintech and space, records a memorandum between the two computer emergency response teams and carries an offer to share open-source health digital infrastructure. Neither memorandum's text is held.	ADVANCED

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Hyperscaler cloud region in Nigeria	An AWS, Azure or Google Cloud announcement of a Nigerian cloud region or local availability zone, or a ministerial statement of terms offered to secure one.	2026-08-04
Power sequencing plan for the data-localisation deadline	A CBN, NITDA or Ministry of Power statement sequencing grid and data-centre capacity milestones against the 2027-01-01 localisation deadline.	2026-08-04
Public breach disclosure regime	An NDPC or NCC rule requiring breach notifications to be published, or an annual register of notified breaches naming the controllers involved.	2026-08-04
Published interoperability framework under the NIMC Act 2026	A gazetted regulation or published framework stating the lawful basis, consent mechanism, retention rule and audit arrangements for inter-agency sharing of identity data – or the gazetted text of the Act itself.	2026-08-04
Whether foreign cloud local zones satisfy the localisation directive	A CBN clarification, FAQ or supervisory letter stating whether a hyperscaler's in-country availability zone meets the storage-and-management requirement of circular PSS/DIR/PUB/CIR/001/004.	2026-08-04
Consolidated federal budget allocation to digital transformation	A Budget Office appropriation extract or Ministry of Communications, Innovation and Digital Economy annual report carrying total digital and ICT spend across votes.	2026-08-04
Proposed responsible-AI governance framework for public bodies	The instrument, terms of reference or ministerial statement establishing the proposed responsible-AI governance framework for public institutions.	2026-08-14
Malabo Convention ratification position	An instrument of signature, ratification or accession to the African Union Convention on Cyber Security and Personal Data Protection, or an official statement of the government's position on it.	2026-08-14

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This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.